out loud to himself, just to relieve the monotonous silence of the room. They formerly saw nothing of the Persians, never visited with them and I suspect knew very little of what was going on in the country. Col Farrant is a very different man. Last year he ran a four in hand sledge at Erzeroom. None of the horses having been in harness before and now I understand he is going to ride a tandem about Tehran. Many Persians have set up carriages but the streets are so narrow that they are obliged to keep them outside the town; in the neighbourhood the roads are not bad, that is for Persia.

The Greek merchants are much frightened because an English house has set up at Shiraz. They think and not without some reason that the British trade may be drawn that way. That it may pass through Busheer instead of Trebizonde. Unless the Englishmen who are established at Sheeraz are very sharp fellows they can not compeat with the Greeks who are the cleverest merchants I have ever seen. There are already three houses here all of them extensive, and another in a small way, more I expect will be coming. Their trade is almost entirely with Manchester where they have agents. They have driven the Persians and English almost entirely out of the trade. The Persians formerly went to Constantinople and bought goods of the English settled there; now that trade has almost entirely ceased and the same goods come here through the Greeks direct from Manchester. There is some talk of the Russian Government allowing British goods to enter Georgia at a small duty if this takes place the trade of Tabreez will suffer much.

P. S.: I have not thanked you for the book you so kindly sent me viz "Howitts visits to remarkable places."[91] It has interested me much altho I am not acquainted with the places he describes. It stirs up in me that love of country which is so strong in all Englishmen and when reading it I think how little I have seen of my own country.

[Edward Burgess to Mrs. Henry Burgess]* *Tabreez, July 4, 1845*

I wrote to you by last post probably the *7th* or *8th* ult. and since then I have to thank you for yours of the 10*th* May. I am glad you liked my Persian writing and if I thought you had not had enough I would send you some more of it. You seem to think this hand writing complex. It something resembles what answers to round hand. I must send you a specimen of the hand writing called "shekesteh" broken, much of which resembles fishhooks one within the other. There is one thing which makes writing or speaking in Persia agreeable, it is this: That unlike England where most people write and speak English perfectly well, and where

[91] Howitt, William. *Visits to remarkable places, old halls, battle fields, and scenes illustrative of striking passages in English history and poetry.* London, 1840.

* Unless otherwise noted, all letters in this installment are to Mrs. Burgess.

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